

✔ WHAT TO COOK — CURRENT STATE (SUMMARY)

The current *What To Cook* page is built for **screen display**, not print. As a result:

Layout Structure

- Each day is represented as a **card** in a multi-column **grid**.
- Inside each card are **meal blocks**, each with:
 - A meal header
 - An ingredients list
 - A nested user breakdown list (each user and their portion)

Styling

- Cards use spacing, padding, margins, borders, and visual separation.
- Ingredients and user breakdowns use nested layout structures that take up vertical space.
- The design is optimized for interaction and clarity, not space efficiency.

Print Behavior

- When printing, the full grid layout is preserved.
- Each card retains its card-like structure.
- Nested user breakdowns and ingredient layouts introduce large amounts of vertical whitespace.
- Because of this, **printing a single week typically consumes 11–13 sheets of paper**.
- Even small fonts don't help because the *structure* forces content to expand.

✔ DESIRED STATE — COOKBOOK-STYLE PRINT LAYOUT

The printed version should resemble a **professional weekly cooking plan page**, similar to a cookbook or meal kit recipe sheet:

Key Goals

- Fit the entire 7-day plan on 1–2 pages.
- Use a **single, vertical, flowing layout** instead of cards in a grid.
- Condense ingredients and user breakdowns into compact, readable lines.
- Include faint background images (“hero meal images”) behind some days for aesthetic effect.
- Maintain perfect readability even when images are present.
- Keep the screen layout unchanged — changes apply only to the printed version.

✔ CHANGES REQUIRED TO REACH THE DESIRED EFFECT

Below is the conceptual transformation required — the *what*, not the *how*.

1. Replace the grid of day-cards with a single-column vertical layout for print

- The grid layout should be removed entirely when printing.
- Each day becomes a simple **section** stacked vertically.
- Sections must allow natural page flow so printing doesn't break awkwardly.

Effect: Major reduction in width & spacing → fewer pages.

2. Remove “card” styling in print mode

- Borders, backgrounds, padding, drop shadows, and card spacing should be removed or minimized.
- The printed design should look like a **clean document**, not a UI.

Effect: Removes visual bulk & whitespace.

3. Flatten the meal + ingredient structure into dense, simple text blocks

- Meal blocks become simple text headings.
- Ingredient entries become **one-line entries**.
- User breakdown lists should collapse into shorthand appended to the ingredient line:
 - Example: (W:1 / M:0.5 / B:1)

Effect: Eliminates deep nesting that wastes vertical space.

4. Optionally restructure the day header hierarchy

- Day name (e.g., “Tuesday, Dec 9”) becomes a **text heading**.
- “Prep Ahead” and “Cook Today” become small **subheadings** rather than blocks.
- Section accents should be minimalistic: possibly a thin line or color cue.

Effect: Traditional cookbook readability.

5. Add optional faint background food images (hero images)

- Some days may include a large, faint, grayscale, low-opacity food photo behind the text.
- The image must **not** interfere with readability — must act as a watermark.
- Only a few meals should include imagery (1–3 for the whole week).

Effect: Professional, polished cookbook aesthetic.

6. Ensure text always remains readable over images

Options:

- Use a semi-translucent light panel behind the text.
- Keep hero images extremely faint (5–8% opacity).
- Apply desaturation or slight blur to images.

Effect: Food images look good without hurting legibility.

7. Hide all interactive UI elements in print mode

- Buttons like “Show Nutrients”, “Meal Instructions”, etc. should not appear in print.
- Controls, icons, and non-essential UI chrome should be removed.

Effect: Clean, printable document without screen-specific controls.

8. Maintain the screen version exactly as it is today

- All structural, layout, and visual changes apply **only to @media print**.
- The on-screen experience remains fully card-based and interactive.

Effect: No disruption to the existing user flow.

 SUMMARY OF THE TRANSFORMATION

From:

- Card-based
- Grid layout
- Deeply nested ingredient structures
- Screen-optimized spacing
- No background imagery
- 11–13 page printouts

To:

- Single-column vertical layout
- Dense cookbook-style text formatting
- Condensed ingredient + user breakdown lines
- Minimalistic section styling
- Faint hero meal images behind text
- 1–2 page total print output

All **screen mode** remains **unchanged**; all changes happen inside **print mode**.

If you'd like, I can also generate:

-  A version of these instructions written as a **task breakdown** for Codex
- OR
-  A version written as a **Pull Request description**
- OR
-  A **checklist** Codex can follow automatically